Secret Restaurant List

茨城の秘密の店

Eat like a local, one hour from Tokyo.

MITO
NAKAMINATO
NAKA
& ALL IBARAKI



by *Kaho*

MAPS · DAY PLANS
MANNERS · OMIYAGE

HELLO!

Welcome to my Ibaraki 🍙



Hi, I'm Kaho! I live in Ibaraki and share real life in rural Japan on YouTube and TikTok. This book is my honest favorites: the bakeries I hop on my day off, the soba I take my family to, the yakitori and yakiniku after a long workday. Let's eat like locals! 😋

🤫 **17 secret spots**
My personal favorites in Mito & Hitachinaka, with my tips

🏆 **Top 30 in Ibaraki**
The highest-rated restaurants, with price & access

🗾 **Ibaraki basics & maps**
Getting here, maps, best seasons

🙇 **Manners, words & tips**
Easy Japanese, what to pack, omiyage

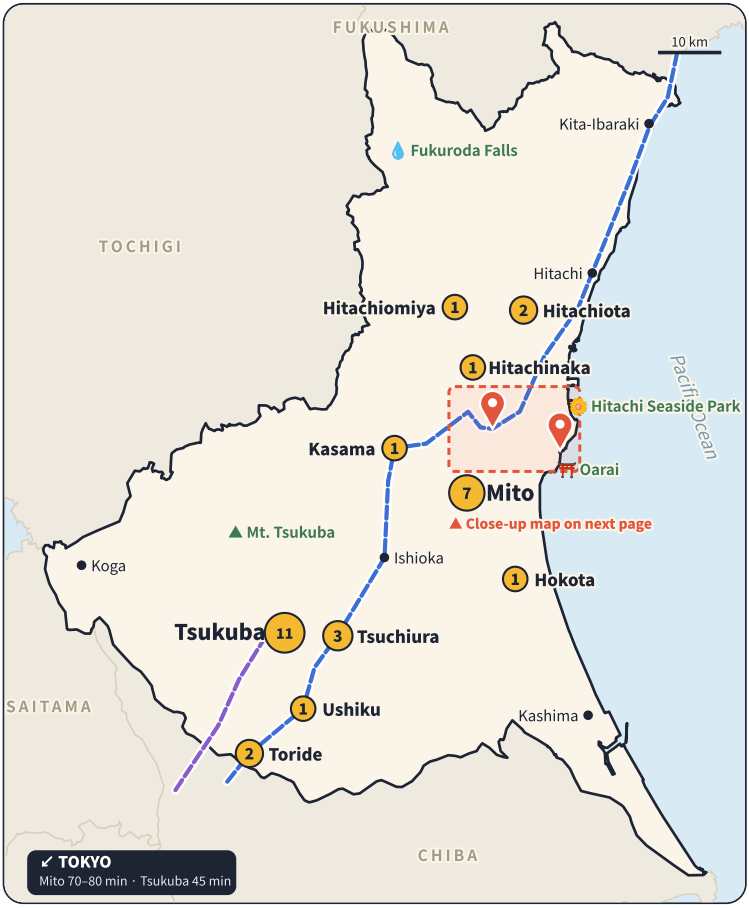
🚃 **Train OK** Easy on foot from the station
🚕 **Taxi / bus** A short ride from the station
🚗 **Car needed** Countryside. Almost no buses
📍 Tap any map link to open Google Maps

Hours and closed days were checked in November 2026 but can change. Please check before you go. This book is for your own use, please don't share or resell it. Thank you! 💛

WHERE IS IT?

Ibaraki food map 🗺️

Ibaraki is big! My 17 spots are around Mito and the port of Nakaminato. The Top 30 are all over, many in Tsukuba.



Kaho's 17 spots · Top 30 (number of places) · JR Joban Line · Tsukuba Express

No.04

Kanmi ema

甘味 ema（水戸市末広町）



🚕 Taxi / bus

A calm little Japanese sweets café on the approach to Howaen, Mito's hydrangea temple garden. Creative anmitsu, a soba-flour roll cake, rich chocolate cake, and a gentle Japanese lunch. There is a terrace too. The kind of place where you slow down.

KAHO'S PICK

The oyakodon! Yes, at a sweets café. Soft egg, tender chicken, so good. Then have dessert, of course.

⏰ 11:00–17:00
🚫 Closed Wed
💴 ¥1,000–2,000
💳 Card, IC, QR OK

⭐ MUST-ORDER **Oyakodon, then anmitsu or soba roll cake**

📞 RESERVATION **Possible (not needed on weekdays)**

Address 3-2-35 Suehirocho, Mito · 1 min walk from the Howaen-iriguchi bus stop, or about 10 min by taxi from JR Mito Sta. · Parking available

🌸 **Combo:** Howaen hydrangeas are best in June.

📍 Open in Google Maps →

READY-MADE PLANS

My perfect food days 🗓️

Two easy days you can copy. I checked the closed days, so everything is open on the same day.

Day 1 · Mito

Best Thu–Sun

- **7:00** **Kairakuen garden** 🌸 One of Japan's three most famous gardens. Free for everyone until 9:00! (Usually ¥320. Opens 6:00 from mid-Feb to Sep, 7:00 from Oct.)
- **10:30** **good bakes (No.01)** Fresh bread for later. It's downtown.
- **11:00** **Soba lunch at Mikawa (No.13)** Lunch only. On weekends you can't book, so come at opening.
- **13:30** **Howaen + Kanmi ema (No.04)** Temple garden walk (hydrangeas in June), then anmitsu at ema.
- **16:00** **Crepe K'S (No.03)** Tapioca lassi, 5 min from Mito Sta.
- **18:00** **Yakiniku at Ajinoya-tei (No.10)** Book by phone. Bring cash or JCB/AMEX. Or keep it simple: stamina ramen at Matsugoro (No.15, cash only).
- **20:00** **Omiyage at Mito Station** 🎁 Shops are open until about 20:30. See the omiyage page.

Day 2 · Sea & flowers

Not Tue (park closed)

- **8:30** **JR to Katsuta, then the little Seaside Railway** to Nakaminato Sta. (about 15 min). Cute local train!
- **9:40** **Nakaminato Fish Market (No.16)** Line up early for the kaiten sushi (opens 10:00), or have a kaisendon. Walk the port.
- **12:30** **Hitachi Seaside Park** 🌼 Taxi from the market. Nemophila (late Apr–May) or red kochia (Oct). ¥450, kids free. Open about 9:30–17:00.
- **16:30** **Bus back to Katsuta Sta.** About 15 min (East Exit bus stop 2). Dinner in Mito, or Bando Taro (No.12, open every day).

THIS WAS A FREE SAMPLE

Want the *whole* list?

The full book has all 17 of my secret spots, with the real details you need on the day.

- **17** secret spots with hours, closed days, price & how to pay
- **30** top-rated restaurants in all of Ibaraki, with price & access
- **2** maps, so you know where everything is
- **2** ready-made food days you can copy
- **+** manners, Japanese words for eating out, packing tips & omiyage

Get the full book · $9 →

28 pages · PDF for phone and tablet · checked November 2026
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